



FREE GUIDE · FOR URGENT CARE

The Urgent Care Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

High-volume sharps, biohazard, meds, and controls —
every regulated stream, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

High volume, high scrutiny.

Urgent care centers move a lot of regulated waste fast — suturing and injection sharps, red-bag biohazard from procedures, expired medications, and controlled substances for pain. High volume means more chances to slip out of compliance. This guide covers every stream and the simplest compliant way to handle each.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor can take every stream by prepaid mail-back or scheduled pickup, with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Sharps

High volume — suturing, injections, IVs, and procedures.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Needles, syringes & IV sharps
- Suture needles & scalpel blades
- Lancets & procedure sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line and keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 02

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Procedure and wound-care waste soaked with blood or fluids.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked gauze & dressings
- Contaminated PPE
- Specimen waste

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, and retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — over-classifying wastes money.

WASTE STREAM 03

Controlled substances

Schedule II–V pain and procedure medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V
- Wasted procedure/pain doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, complete a DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, and keep witnessed waste logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance / medication mail-back kit, to DEA standards.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

WASTE STREAM 04

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired and unused non-controlled medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired antibiotics & injectables
- Non-controlled analgesics
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Keep any hazardous or controlled drugs separate — they each have their own path.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The urgent-care compliance checklist.

- ☐ Sharps in FDA-cleared containers, replaced at the fill line (high volume — check often).
- ☐ Controlled substances rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41 and witnessed logs.
- ☐ Red-bag biohazard labeled, stored securely, and destroyed.

- ☐ Expired non-controlled meds segregated and destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS URGENT CARE ASKS

Your urgent care questions, answered.

We generate a lot of sharps — what size kit or program?

High-volume sites often mix larger kits with scheduled pickup. We'll size it so you're never overfilling a container.

How do we handle controlled pain meds?

Expired or wasted Schedule II–V drugs are destroyed non-retrievable with a DEA Form 41 and witnessed waste logs.

Mail-back or pickup for urgent care?

Either — mail-back for lower volume, scheduled pickup for higher. We'll recommend based on your volume.

What proof do we get for an inspection?

A Certificate of Destruction on every order — audit-ready for OSHA, DEA, and your state.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle handles urgent-care waste by prepaid mail-back or scheduled pickup for higher volume. We destroy every stream at our DEA-registered facility and return a Certificate of Destruction, with Form 41 handled for controls. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit or pickup
Biohazard / RMW	Biohazard mail-back kit

Waste stream	The right path
Controlled substances	Controlled / medication kit (Form 41)
Expired non-controlled meds	Pharmaceutical waste kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

High-volume urgent care often prefers scheduled pickup over mail-back — we'll size a custom program. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY URGENT CARE CENTERS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your urgent care waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop